

"Modern poetry claims to be a vision, that is to say, a knowledge of hidden, invisible realities. It is true that the poets of all times & all places have said as much. But Homer, Virgil, or Dante insist that their poetry has to do with a revelation that comes from outside themselves: a god or demon speaks through their mouths... The modern poet declares that he is speaking in his own name: he extracts his visions from within himself. The disturbing disappearance of divine powers has coincided with the appearance of drugs as bestowers of the gift of poetic vision. The familiar demon, the muse, or the divine spirit have been supplanted by laudanum, opium, hashish, & more recently, Mexican drugs: peyote (mescaline) & hallucinogenic mushrooms."

—Octavio Paz

"If at some future period of the world's history men should acquire the art of flying, there can be no doubt that migration would become the custom, and whole nations would change their localities. Man has, indeed, been always a migratory animal... What men do only at intervals birds do frequently, having greater freedom of movement."

—Richard Jefferies

—Trapeiro, trapeiro, schlep your thoughts together.

—Bring me something Oriental, something foreignerlover.

Dedicated to St. Ariel & the author age 12.

1

Where are you Child?
Are you in the Tall Grass?
Can you see the Planet's Currents in its arcing Bent?

What brings you leave of Solitude?
Is it the Waves of Wild Oats—
Or just the way they hide you?

Are you avoiding Supper and its Family inquisition?

Are you worn out from Covert Games with the Other Children?

I too have found a Sweet Relief in Prospect & in Refuge
Have wished to live outside Surveillance &
Rest my rusted Mettle from the reckless petty minds that meddle...

But only lifeless worlds are blind, so
everyway we go beheld,
With watchings that repeat themselves:
that groove

The mind & sense of self.

(With violence is a structure built.)

And all the open lines and tethers, open
fronts & bloodless wounds you
probe and question with a queasy
finger...

7:10 São Paulo—
 Centered cell of numbered seats,
 A sleepless press of bodies
 Strain against constraint, containers.

By descent a mindwreck,
 Neck-kinked, bleary, drifting
 Tack & list toward slipspace;
 Wake to sorted rows and rumbled wheel;
 Watch an ad to hop on public network,
 Call a cab & grab a coffee,
 (Summon carriage, Japanese revival)
 Gridded beats from global Starbuck station:
 Shape my mouth in novel ways to
 Make the sounds which soon will come so
 Easily:

—Bonjia, um café com leite—
 —Crôjito; sim, por favor—

A simple favor, would you? Paltry
 Pretense, game politeness, pass my plastic—
 Skip the tip in strange, familiar waters—
 Same old roles in same old Latin.

Up all night that night at
 Plastic tables, round red tables
 Kicking back & clinking glasses with the
 Little cups, that make litros seem so
 abundant.

Myself a dark-eyed junko down at Barra
 funda,
 Watching wildlife the milling
 Rites while Toby reads the room, like

Attenborough, Austen, Doyle:
 Footwear, fanny-pack, the style accents
 assets.

—Couple'a feelers, bottle of fizz—
 —Headin' for boil; simmerin' riz̃z.—

You get a sense at once, he says—
 The head-to-toe assembled parts.
 Harmony in poetry, I link & show a
 spectrogram—
 The bassy din & many tongues
 fastswallowed words;
 I strained to speak of prairie dogs,
 Who yip a sentence in an instant
 Vertisplayed as chord.

—All the girls in little black dresses
 —Touch their lips and twiddle their tresses.

Our chatathon, with frontseat tickets:
 Cars pulled up unloading friends
 And leaving, loaded up on lovers;
 Others coupled on the concrete,
 Some third wheel spun feigned absence,
 Privvy to some ancient cycle:
 Hot-girl summer; cuffing season.
 The dance had little hold
 On husbandeyes wine-darkened,
 Garden-gained, & knowing well the nature
 Of fermented fruit: Still,
 Imagination burnished,
 'Liding all the effort burnt
 In tactics and confusion.

—So close, so far, from Camp Elis
 —A sunken floodplain, skeet release.

Unreal City—Cryptic aerosol alphabet—
 Climbing past the pichação, its
 Pretty pieces—Some provincial up to heaven.

Afterwards, well. I go home, and smoke
 on the street and give butt to
 a beggar. I drink a yoghurt
 and watch a guy go crazy, just
 screaming drunk in another man's
 face. Spot someone squat, and
 shit on the pavement and kick it,
 like a dog. I've been going round,
 photographing the inside of trash
 cans; I've been interested in a
 neighborhood's waste, in its disposal
 systems, in its use of clear &
 colored bags.

And I find O'Hara's "Personism"—surfing,
 back in bed, to fill the empty
 pre-dawn. Looking for voices; still
 not liking the sound of my speech,
 & mimicking music of others.

And because all these foreign placenames
 make me think of Frank,
 Who loved to write his lines like letters,
 I settle it then & there, to write this poem
 to
 Ariel, my brother, Kris, my boyhood self.

*

—As the laundry women'd say—
 —Amante especial, oi vei—

At the service counters, clients
 Tracking comedramas of their catenary
 Clientele (For if one must thus pay
 attendance,
 Ought enjoy the bought performance.)¹

¹ And if one plans to buy a pair of pants, one
 Ought as well to get them tight, so anyone'll bed you.
 —O'Hara, "Personism"

Anteros had flown down, hence the chatter:
 We were in the process
 Of deciding where to live,
 And how. A course of trips to tell:
 From New World to the Old;
 From yesteryear's province now tomorrow's
 core;

We wanted a Latinate language;
 Wanted a neutral passport, in event of
 war.

Two to three dozen inches of rain;
 Warmish weather year-round and a little
 land,

To call our Kingdom;
 Nonstop flights to Newyork, for our
 Short-run social re-up missions.

It was hard, projecting yourself
 Into some imagined future—
 Guessing at the form you'd take on
 fifteen years and half a million bucks.
 The more we saw, the more it seemed
 arbitrary,
 Where we settled. Spreadsheets helped
 To take the Romance out of Romance
 language.

O My Goldenfleece Girl; on your last day
 We drove to Camburi, down the coast—
 I was virgin when it came to açai, you
 know,

Me first time really getting it,
 And the gilded stray who limped, before we
 Lept from solid rocks to flowing pool below
 and

Used the roots like ropeswing in the
 Magic hour's aur'ate spray.

Of course we all thought of Tarzan—
 We'd all seen the movie, hadn't we?—
 And the mere mention of tu/can lent a

scent
And charged the scene of our descent with
possibility.

Ô Mãe d'Água—
Early morning rising singing
Walking sandy sickle, bullion shore,
Along the veined & fatty sea &
Feeling young, eternal perched on
Billion-year-old boulders, under ancient
skies & all the
Tidelines marked by barnacle, &
Not me crying, "Not this time!"
To loneliness, who many times before had
tried
To wash upon these rocks of mine.

5

And driving long the skyway,
When the tunnel opened up on such big
blue
We played a Bushy "Big Sky"—Kate's—&
sang along, all
Shouldershaking—
Lost in flows, we nearly drove right off the
ledge.

And then dropped at the airport poor
Anteros—
Actually, she took a car.
After she was gone I rearranged the dining
room.
Turned the TV on Megachurch &
Christian infomercial.
And I went to work for many hours,
In the darkness, under MAC—hum,
& neither ate nor left until the sun rose
On the third of days...

Then so giddy, kicking, skipping on the
sidewalk,
Like San Xóbal, singing
Mama, Mama, Mama
Don't take my kodachrome away.

My mustache died a perma-purple, sipping
those elixirs.
Such good times, I'd stumble downstairs
past the doorguard
find a table on the sidewalk, wait to say
The same words every time, a joy just
getting right:
—Bonjia, todorem. Dois ovos, sim,
meshidos—
—E café com leite—e um suco com laranja,
por favor—

And most times getting what I'd wanted,
hoped and tried for.
Well, I won't trouble you with a theory
of language
But it felt like singing, and it felt like
magic.

And Cris? We were to spend a month
together.
He'd been learning to read the city—
Blockquote, concrete syntax, gridded layout.
Taking the same walk everyday & seeing
what happened—
How the parts fit—Perce counting cars—
He was writing about Parisian corn carts:
About mass & readymade units adapted
Into custom forms, over years and
generations.
He was interested in
lightweight/portable/nomadic
architecture.

In minimum-viable rigs.
The natural, everyday look of lighter

Coverage could not fool him.
 He always noticed people's shoes;
 I mentioned Frost, abroad.
 An exlover in Janeiro—
 "that's the thing about Kris; he's
 always looking."
 She said he was a gringo, for the way he
 wore his fannypack.
 (Insufficiently guarded).
 She said he was a gringo, for translating
 "polvinho" to
 Tapioca dust.

6

Heaven's hammock lulled us
 Singing long to Dylan
 Merica's new folk song canon:
 "Graceland," "Country Roads" & Newman

Bobby with his breathless beat-rap ²
 Cosmic Cassady, ecstatic
 Dana Ward and Manley Hopkins
 ("Leaden Echo," read by Burton)

"One who sings with tongue on fire":
 Lit by Guthrie, lit up Davy;
 Lizardking is flying, crying
 "Girl, we couldn't get much higher."
 So a network relays power.

As kingfisher bares its breast,
 And embers wake by oxidation,
 Musement warms a mailed loin, and
 Collins, dissertating terms,³
 Built networks in ergetic transfer:
 Motion motivates emotion.

—Mitchell splices plus & minus;⁴
 —Mary's doctor galvanizes.

(Frankenstein the café site of
 Beatnik luau-bamboo hat, a Byron goat's
 Leading sixteen-something babes in
 Martial forms of meditation:
 Fifties haunt Laguna Beach In geometric
 visitation.)

And what profits prophet?
 fasting, foreign soils;
 Substance, contemplation?
 fasting, isolation, altered states & novel
 inputs;

Excess to perturb the system;
 (Cycle-slain not far from Dixby)

...Avid phrasing... measured breath, a
 Trumpet... magic scribbles... blowing on a
 subject;

Anaphoric rhythm, vital dash, and speechy
 pauses...

Sensitive fellers, indulgent of transient
 desires.

First thought right thought,
 Cocky chestpuff,
 Messi instinct improv,
 Camp'd Mars athletics.

² Swinton's Roland-Knausgaard nods—"No final form
 enclosed him."

³ Randall, *Sociology of Philosophies*.

⁴ Toni, "Electricity".

The local network covered Cris's gym.
Reporter came around,
Everyone was real excited.

She said, You're our new leder:
Climbing is the new Tinder.
The youth were meeting in person,
It was a big story.

—Oh, sure, a global trend
—Maybe you caught it—

Got me in with a guestpass—
We watched them work their form & plan
their routes &
Build their bodies. Some attempted
ledger—record,
Testing Heavens; Some gave lessons,
To pretty girls,
And others ground their grip strength.

And when the weather was good?
Sneaking in the med school's pool—
Peering through the windows long the path;
Lessons learned on grappling mats,
Strength in opposition training;
Girls & boys in volley courts for
trophyed golden
coated brass...

Green oasis waters: emptytranquil,
sun-warmed waters.
Then the clockstrike, with its
~~WUNDERCAMPAIGN TO MORE~~
Cueing mass migration:
First, the piscine plain is
Subdivided / so: the open / water's made
to
Lanes by stretched & twining wireflow, &

Swimmers take their place by speed &
Space is hieraragui'd.
How easily we come to share
When lines / are laid / on pavement bare.

Or stand erect in humus soil, constancy
abetting coil,
Letting life know air...

But now on darkened streets I pass the
feeding troughs, & all the faces
Turned w/in, toward shout & flag &
Colored card w/ preassigned allegiance.

We were primitives of a future unknown.
Hot oats mixed with champagne mango:
So much better than I'd imagined
Butter helped.

You put the mask in masculine, she said,
& dried off with a towel.
The clouds above us seemed to form a
lattice;
Covered and uncovered sun, in balanced
alternation:
Light showers coming in and out,
Cooling us, drying us.

We hiked down to the pool near every other
day;
A red & digital display kept pace.
The steps of brutalist arena, in a steep
ravine.
In between the cracks of crumbling habit,

flourished many weeds,
 Throbbing green, Triassic:
 Framed lens. Banned rays.
 Marbled fat & muscle hung on
 Hook & strap & rack & splayed on
 Slab & dripping up on blocks or
 Oilslicked or stripped pink for
 Braising bruising browsing here a
 Breastkid there a tenderloin, a
 Leg so plucked & plump, a tempting
 Aged shank a lean appraisal,
 Stretching tanning hide and charring
 Sear—a prime cut, make an offer, check
 her measures—

Stop!
 These degen'rate games,
 They get me down.

Drag me back in time & place,
 Gone gnostic, pulled at woven strands.

10

—Grā Grayhouse, grow like grāo &
 upgrade.—

Chlorine cleansed us.
 Toweled-off to sunshowers,
 Mechanized carriage past Água Branca,
 Villa Country's block of falsefront bars
 With cowhide seats & leather saddles,
 Chandeliers of purchased antlers.
 I toured by satellite that night, and
 panorama—
 Prepped for 'piacaba, playing out a
 podcast.
 Swore while taking notes it'd be my best
 performance—
 Hoped to ~~ARP~~: Like All Romantic Poets,

Some dead-end nostalgic trip.
 Dead in sense but somehow speaking,
 Songlines, dreaming clew, were seeking.
 And see what it was like, I guess—
 I'd known a girl from Barnard, loved her
 Keats above the rest.
 (Her character had not impressed.)
 And if the form might suit me with some
 tailoring, as guest.

And learned that Manley Hopkins had been
 born of
 A marine insurer, who could safekeep
 Lords against the wreck of craft, but could
 not
 Spare a crew or captain.

(Like bark, must get the wind in me,
 The breath in me, of God & West &
 Pass it on to others, butte to distant butte,
 As pyre's second fuel.)

What comfort of a Catholic to a psyche
 in a whitcapped water:
 Stillness in a churning world; Ocean saveth
 every curl
 Of thy pale daughter.

Hopkins haunted by a woman's resurrection:
 Penned his finest cantos, worshipping at
 Winifred, whose wellspring sprung up
 where beheaded.

So willowrun, where downbound flow
 Allows an upward growing.
 'Long the bank of fallow fields,
 Waiting for their sowing.

While Byron, Perce & Polidori: Peacocks
 all & Theban poets—
 Boating with the boys while Mary
 watches—

This is what I learn, for instance, from
 Distelli on the speakers—
 These Romantics not romantic
 Much beyond the Year of Cotton.
 Harriet? Was not invited—
 Riverdrowned, a Virgin's pebbles—⁵
 Godwin's wishful thinking tested;
 Bob & Toni's offroad freedom
 Slave to courtship, Hudson's Stetson...⁶

—A doubt: And who am I to play at
 rockstar?—

Short-lived tactic, tackless,
 Drowned they all &
 Drowned were they who loved them.
 Drowned they were who followed.
 Drowned they were who lustful set
 No greater cause above it.

11

The plan was—
 To walk, drink tea & mumble in the wood,
 Half-savage in an Industrial Age,
 And sing to birds, & squeak a caller's zinc
 on birch,
 And make strange sounds meant for myself,
 And treat the voice as instrument, as men
 before had done
 But mostly tried & failed
 (Mine would be another failure)
 To make of type a moltenmetal—
 Blended space a better place—
 Which was not dissimilar
 To the brass instruments
 Of my youth.

(For how the fretless trombone flummoxed,
 yet a student's slide is taped, and,
 all its open space is snapped to
 gridded notes correct,
 Implying in their midst an error.

As for myself, my bugle was hard-coded
 with a keyed-up grid,
 To keep in tune with teammates.
 Metal merely modulates what's buzzing in
 the mouth;
 I lacked the bravery, perhaps.
 Unlike the brassy Beats who were—must
 it be said?—
 A new Romantics.)

But blended also in the Wakeish sense of
 harmony,
 Where each word is really three or four
 words spliced—
 And all of this, the brass, the blending,
 Part of my new theory of practice,
 Which I called vox libre,
 Its manifesto penned at lunch,
 As Frankie once had done it.
 Or really in the House of the Owls, Rome,
 And which only a handful know about,
 And fewer understand.

12

—Snap from drift & dry the hands on
 dishrag—
 —Sigh lightly—
 —Have to skip again I guess—
 —Tap through time by working back in
 increments of ten.

Beats, at least, was protean and modest,
 Like the song of starlings,

⁵ p1.03.28
⁶ Rock's Rex, Pillow Talk

Cupped self to carry world,
Bring the outside in.

Wordsworth, though, an egoist—
Distelli here a moralist—
His poets more like alchemists
As Jung conceived them:
Soulsmiths, much as wordsmiths;
Mimicked, modelled mindset,
As Girard would then perceive them.

—Whatchu looking at? Shit.—

And why'd you speak the subtle thing out
loud?

In florried snow is buried Robert Frost,
New England's famed pasture poet.
All a means to butter parsnips.

Whose reading was lowercase catholic;
Who leafed through anthology;
Who sought to know & move all kinds:
Here are the pearls that were his eyes:
No caviar! He sought a subtler
Quality in tonal tenor, shied from all
Performance of his learned reference.
How his rusted tributes like a standard
shame me.

New leaf; another ten and ten;
Wetfingered triple-tap to learn
That poets were athletes, men of physical
prowess.

Humble men, these minstrels.
Wishfully wanting to be any but
themselves:

To be farmer, fisherman, boxer or smith.
Sweat over ink-stain, Earnest ol' Olson,
wrestling bulls.

A labor of the hand, a poem, like
rhythms of a scythe while swishing

meadows:

Softly spoken, cutting down the ranks. I'm
on a digression but how do I get
used to the everyday violence of
gardening, is what I'm always
asking. Because there's something
fascist (no?) in pruning branches,
weeding roots. Well. I've gotten
away from plot, and will the editor
kindly leave these?)

Ten and also Robert studied talky rhythms
(So did Ginsberg. So did Gaddis.
Frankie surely; Bobby)

Listened to their music, tried to imagine how
they'd sound through walls,
Freed from con or denotation, muffled—
Almost molten—out of all distinction.

Pound had showed him jiu-jitsu, sure, in
Eager silence—showed him bohemia,
flipped him head & heel in some cafe.
Frost was just as strong; he hadn't been
ready.

Just as clever as Pound, just as wellread.
Read more Greek than Pound, he reckoned.
His American shoes—they gave him away.
Knew more Latin, so his friends said.
An instinct, deep within him, said to stay
away from gangs.

He never forgot Ole Ez tho.
Busted him right the heck outta jail,
Settled it with the big AG., just like that.
That's what you get for being famous.
When you're poet for the lawyers, and not
just fellow poets.

He'd read Emerson—

Who hadn't?
Never owned a desk—
Who needs one?

He reckoned himself an infinite.
He talked in contradictions.
Whitman played without a net.
But grids assist in their arrest,
He flattered himself.
Who didn't?

He went his own way
Inspired Frank to write a song.
Who are we kidding?
Frankie didn't write his songs, but I will.

Don't we all, these days?
No.
Assembling fragments.
Didn't we all these days?
No.
Immemoried notice.
The lecture was very persuasive.
Afterward, hand-in-hand with his high
school sweetheart,
He renounced the concept of intellectual
property,
And burned with shame
For his love of indie rock.



14

That was fifteen years ago.
Send my roots your rain, O Lord,
To write one work that wakes.

Near ides, ride JWR to outskirts,
Catch a bus: Paranapiacaba.
Railtown of long-set sun,
In canyon where the mountains break
So fog advances with the trains
And pulls into the station.

But on half-sunny days I find
A higher kind of hedonism:
Bougainvillea, staging of me own
transcendence:
Peak at plastitropic lower canopy through
lover shutters.
Smile warm to traduttore traditore
Hostess of her hometown:
Tories sleeping in the kitchen.
(There's a law against that.)

So smooth she is in service
Seen our kind a hundred times before and
will, again—
We glide up to the bar where she's
Presiding over leisure center,

Move our mouths, per-form for
native-tongue appraisal,
Try not to offend her.

-In the yard os pássaros pause &
pulse-perch-
-Branch to phototropic branch-
-And in the grassblades, guava's windfall-
-Rapid-gathered by the ants.-

That night we many write in father-ink
that bleeds, among a
Graveyard: matchsticks, blackened splicoff
these tubes with charcoal tips, with
Ends that burn & ends that do the burning.

While distant train loops 5ths in 6/,
On a swivel like an owl's neck the
Camera tracks me as I move,
Naked between bed & bath &
Light a cigarette-

Or write, which must be why she said-
-Ele é um escritor-
How now can I act, without performing
for her gaze?
Tlamatini, man of mirrors.
(More like topiera.)

15

Do I dare project a self?
And let world fall away?
Do I dare Adamic Act, & fashion handles,
so to wield
Worldforces with a wet & wily muscle,
To repair the pump that vandals damaged,
From whose spring proceedeth science.
How will I choose a form? How will I

choose a life?
When on this morn I cannot choose
between my butter knives.

16

All is long, is long, is long.
All is long-

Every thing talks back, when we're alive
(A heron taught me that.)

Fall asleep in foreign fields,
Foreign drifting slowly yields.

Red fruit in the sun-faced green of the
high-branched tree.

Morning's energetic harvest now announced
by feathered flutes, and

Green sun-panelled flapping fans that move
within the Planet's currents:

Breeze that passes through the guavas,
carries chatting prattle of the
parrots, whistling

"Oh que buceeeeno" and "I'm talking
to-ehyou."

And through the branches
Heavenrays-tempted in my
own sick way to say--

Brigado to the old Brigades whose cutting
brought me here today.

Can hear their echo of past presence.
Quiet forms, machete whack!

Of breakerpath, in
fallenstem & structure-

State of the Green Tower, in the
Age of Metal, singing,

-Chattanooga answers / And your ma'am

in Tennessee.—

And the mood changes as the goldleaf fades:
Cumulated cover which at first relieves will
now not lift; a
Cricket trill announces us the end of little
world, like some
Rose in garden 'Adonis.'⁷

Invading ginger enters at the clearcut,
Roadcut, in the slash-mowed marginals,
Along the barren no man's rock'n'gravel we
call road.

Which clearing flows through living mesh,
&

Lets me pass, &
Contact's always Contact
With that which Contact's altered.

17

Noon, high noon, thy noon & Tam
Baked into prehistory—
Stonesmelted, Donhumming:
"Well, you wanna get enough sun / but
not too much."

—Wrest controls back from Pleasure
Center⁸—

—Back to business at hand—

Nature as stimulant, intoxicant, another
drug:
Starting to get to a point where triunesweat
unzippers.
Traveling back to High Noon: to a moment
of

Maximum Intensity, when shadows' shields
at their slightest,

And pressurewaves whose radiation warpeth
man, and burns him up or out.

Watch flutterfly, and unleaving, ants
are bringing off the body of a hard-shelled
giant,
From the shelledland to tunnelsdug.

Radiation warpeth man; he sees the
Raptor in the Turkey.

Nuff to make him paranoid, the sounds
responding to his presence;
Scattersquawk of rustling pheasants.

Make it nearly back to town now, at the
fringes half-reclaimed:
The Warhead windows where the men made
bread now tangled green, as
Heatbeats down upon this unscreened skin,
Brown as a betel-nut in the morning.

—And I have lived the fates of foreign
diets in a for gn behavior.—

—A hunch: perhaps I've been infected;
what I've given, also gotten.—



⁷ Pessoa.
⁸ Jeronbone

Eris and I start sharing voice memos
and since he's been watching *Twin
Peaks*, they're all in the style of
Twin Peaks,

All of them addressed to some elusive
Diane, which is really just the
pet-name used to refer to each
other.

Diane—

February 27th, 7:45 PM or nearly 20:00.
I've never seen so many trees in
my life.

Making my own coffee in the house
out here. My host is an
exmilitary colonel, 5' 4" and
distinctly indigenous, who for
years lived among the Yanomami.
(*Ya-No-Mami*.) He showed me
his collection of bows and blow
darts. They wear bromeliads, made
from feathers, upon their arms, as
if their arms were tree-trunks.

Somehow they've gotten it into their heads
I'm a writer. The Colonel asks
me how many books I've written.
He says, Only children read books
here. Or so I think: We
have been communicating by way
of coarse & broken pidgin Latin.

Diane—

10:27 AM. Coffee on the kettle. My hosts
have offered me a ride into Rio
Grande, where I'll catch the train.
The Colonel offered but if I
wonder if the Señorita is the brains
behind the operations—he may be

excommando but she's the family
strategist. Was it this easy
for blue-eyed bearded Cortez to
conquer the hearts of the Mexico?
Or plume-capped Pizarro, further
south? Poor huéspedes, to slay a
host.

The Señorita is a sweet woman, and she
is also a mother, who loves her
family dearly. Which is what
worries me.

Diane—

1:33 PM. I have arrived in Estação
Luz and will be catching a car
to Jaguaribe. Sorry to hear
about the cold. Hoping it's mere
coincidence, what with the MCO,
if only to assuage my guilt. But
cats will keep you up at night, &
worsen irritation.

Sunday night sleeper works fine with me.
I, too, have had a helluva couple
days & could use the R&R. Turns
out it's hard work, *R&R*ing
as Romantic poet—at least if
you come to it with something
approaching Protestant ethic. Still,
the trip was beyond words—I leave
satisfied that I have gotten in and
out clean.

Mobile storehouse,
 Hip-secured from
 Sticky fingers, artful dodger
 Bur or barb or claw or bristle.

Plunge into a sweating sea:
 Sunbrellas, togas, boas, leis, and
 Tridents, fishnets, highwaist jorts, and
 Devil horns, and angel wings at
 Elocos.

"Are you single?" "Yes"
 Is pure permission
 When a subject's tacit.
 Gabe is here, he says,
 To drink & piss & french
 In any order; you say:
 If a shark stops swimming...

Small tiff among sardines near
 Startles up stampede, with
 Defense read as offense
 In an escalating cycle...

And all the boys are talking tactics
 "Should I play the gringo? Feign
 pronunciation?"
 Foakleys, funk, & Rita Leona
 Asking for a tongueless kiss
 Then going in for bite.

-Rest now, under stonefruit tree-
 -Notice bottom branches bare.-

Some of us still shy with Western sickness
 speech
 Glissandos fallen wrong side of the Yerkes
 & Dodson, think:
 "Obliterate this sudden fucking fear, this

inwardness," while

Chanting stomping rain dance round the
 Water truck as burly men lift
 Longgthicc waterhose & spray a
 Begging sweating bareskinned crowd so
 Loud & rowdy; later on, at lunch
 (For this was still the morning)
 I transform to Jesus by infusion: Smoke
 &

Awning shade & suca, vitaminas e azucar.

-Are You Sick and Tired of Being Sick
 and Tired Topy?
 -Do You require Speech in Prophets'
 Perfect Tense to shake you from
 your Slumber?

Or in January's city,
 Plastic surgeon pees,
 Cosmetic sex & preening.

-Coughing on the couch by day- -The
 goblins eat their takeaway.-

Booze brigade of fairybears march
 Sharing, caring, underground.
 Which echoed loudly like an anthem-
 Others in the tunnels joined them.
 Contagious as a Flemish painting:
 Pieter the Elder, maybe.

Cris provides a live translation
 As the train arrives in station:

-I'd love to pour oil all over your hide-

-Why? To watch your boomboom slide.-

22

Palm fronds gently dance a hula while
you're flayed & sizzled.

Towel-talking, loving language.

Wondering which were perfect popsongs of
a poem, like

Frankie's "Coke", and which were perfect
poems of popsongs?

Cohen's "Suzy", Toni's "Kai.ouT"-

All of them (not "Drufrock") love-ode.

While blue ships on a blue horizon
Read in cross-hatch rival currents.

And shifting gaze past Sugarloaf,
Toward shaggy loafing lovers,
Sharing sodas, lemon m&ate, seasoned meat
It's mating season, meet'n'greet in pidgin
Latin.

While blue ships on blue horizon
Drive toward trucks to trudge loads inland.

-Under pitched sunbrellas:-

-Picturesque young Cinderellas.-

In portal promise of a paperback partake:
Omegaverse's wolfish sense of
het-romantasy.

23

Forever & always in the age of glass
The age of windowshopping
Love, & sex, in crackt arcades
A tablet trance to faraway beach

In this, our Touring Twenties,
Testy, wanderyears sans wonder,
Picqued by pretty pictures,
Maxwing slain on false azure,
On subtlegridded portal promise,
Shallow light reflecting depth there.

24

That night catch bossa in the old cantina;
Cold beer lifting heat like evening
Breeze, & kiddies craning cameras
Skin as brown as betel-nuts, and
Airy hymns from half-caught eras.

And midnight on the Sambodromo:
From our chairs we chatted
Charted floats slowprogress
Chanting crowd incanting chorus
Lowd & rowdy
Cheering stars who flaunt & shake &
Flow to rhythmic current
Down the corso's
Shoreline, costumed cosplay torsos
Fest of fat and fleshy skin and
Winkless sleep slowsetting in,
The Sun King and his sinking Queen
Their crowns of rays
Their solar spokes arrayed
In radiating angle
Tended by a bend of angels
Featherwinged, free of fetters
Wringing salt from festive tatters
Fire-singed and filing, singing
(Not trivial in tropic weathers)
Wending toward the barricades, the
Great brigades of cosplay tribes, the
Front-row seats secured by bribes.

"O céu vai clarear

Iluminar a zona oeste da cidade
E Deus vai desfilar
Pra ver o mago recriar a Mocidade

A luz que nos chega da estrela primeira
Nascida do pó no Cruzeiro do Sul
Do plasma divino das mãos carpinteiras
Ressurge candeia no breu nesse azul
Será que o limbo da imaginação
Perverte a inteligência
O homem com sua ambição
Desconhece a razão desatina a Ciência
Será que há de ter carnaval, sem minha
cadência?
Com alas em tom digital
No fim da existência
Me diz afinal quem há de arcar com as
consequências?

Se a Mocidade sonhar
No infinito escrever
Versos a luz do luar, deixa!
Quando o futuro voltar
A juventude vai crer
Que toda estrela pode renascer

O verde adocido da esperança
Ofega sobre o leito da cobiça
Quem vive pelo preço da cobrança
Derrama sua lágrima postiça
Fogo matando a floresta
Bicho morrendo no cio
Febre no pouco que resta
Secam as águas do rio
E a vida vai vivendo por um fio
Naveguei
No afã de me encontrar eu me emocionei
Lembrei da corda bamba que atravesssei
São tantas as viradas desta vida
A mão que faz a bomba se arrepende

Faz o samba e aprende
A se entregar de corpo e alma na avenida."

25

Carne-leave: Roman remnant diasporic
fatty Tuesday excess 'fore the lean-mean
Wednesday Lent.

But here the party never ends.

We bid farewell to flesh and set out towards
some

Beautiful Horizons, in the General Mines.

Pack padkos for the journey;

Morning spent in Gurlé's garden:

Genus sung to Jagger's violent
ictus-accent,

Every beat in stress:

-Lit/tle In/vi/an fig,-

-Where is your ownnnnn skin?-



And near a chapel perilous, on sugarcane
plantation hill,

O thousand-trunked tree all webbed &
curtained

By your symbiotes, your rounded staghorn
scales, browning 'bove

Bromeliads, which brace & cup your
branches, catching rain.

Learn of leite politics while driving
 Through the lactate kingdom of a lesser
 time, a
 State a stage in process, forming,
 History informing, never blank—start always
 twisting
 Writting, snaking; breaking down the self
 To build another up:

"Curral, cabresto, comitiva
 Tropa, tronco, guided gridd
 Cito'n'lavoura, grooved carreira in alignment
 Oscillating oligarchs in
 Vin'n Vang collapsing
 Milk from young Republica, &
 Frothed en gran fazenda..."

By lateish afternoon we'd reached
 Hill country, pastureland where
 Shimmerwaves wind-racing cross the faces,
 Silver quickflow in the fore as

Pearl-lined clouds enormous,
 Currentpulled with all the rest, peck Godly
 light,
 While we atop indifferent engine,
 Bubbleglass enveloped barely sense it.
 Cris puts in his upper-decky soaring
 Carving in through shadowpatch and
 picbalds,
 Unfenced ungulates, us setting out to
 Cuntry
 from the Seedy, Os Mutantes, male
 movement.

—And underneath the hanging vines—
 —A chessboard, gridded black & white &—
 —Inlaid into concrete table.—

Then drove from old Petrópolis, where some
 long-lost writer lived & died & got
 a street named after him.

We play Genesis to Exodus, & skip
 around Ecclesiastical to Solomon,
 on Bluetooth speakers; & I asked:
 How far is proverb anyway, from catchy
 everyday cliché?
 (Well, Cris said, a chiliad. We left it
 there.)



The Beats wrote odes to Menfriends,
 Breaking from tradition—
 Troubadors and Bedouins—Instead—
 Sung ballads of heroic age to
 Celebrate the courage of their boys, in
 War with the Machine.

And of mereness at night bejewelled
 By other steersmen, ancient world.
 Hard to not see God herein the pasture.⁹

⁹ Secession from modernity. Regression to an earthworm
 life among medieval peasants, types the Teron, bored.

Sitting on a park bench, Tiradentes, when
you texted.

Said: "To feel the cool of rain & heat of
sun at once—

That is a higher pleasure"

This lucky duck gets to see a
Sun dog on phanerothymes, gets to see an
Abbiocco in breeze-blocks, while Cris
Reads out on his Anki.

Perched among the stoneflower,
Starseed, phototropes while
Roots reach down, commensurate
With upward motion—
Sky-grasp by a strong foundation—

And speaks of fabled Brasil lightness,
Burdened less by static contracts—
In support he quotes Calvino;
Cards to read in native language.

27

Scavenge, deconstruction zone
On red pared that leads uphill
Unto the Church of Anthony,
Of thousand feathergold rocailles
Plant-dyed red rocococo.

On laudinum, my thoughts turned in—
choate and porous, reading old
inscription
"Laud him thus in chord & chorus, organ,
corpus"
Golden awe by self-description.

Walls all packed with whale, grass
And cowshit, hardened mud, the
Greeks, Chinese, & Arabs carved, so

Slanted eyes on half the cherubs
Hybrids of império era.



And ninety days by mule for music,
Putrefactive oozing up from
floorboards for the patron's pleasure
Incense lit in steamy weather
Brides brought in bouquets to stifle
Smell of death with life, or something close:
The cellulose of life-stem snipped
And stripped of lignin, pressed
In sheets to take impress, collect
In this anthologize & wrecking prize:
Ninety days by mule.

28

O Ariel!
How have you become so heavy?
Bound in arborescence
By maternal witch.
When will you surge aerial,
And sing a higher pitch?

O Ariel:
Now though you serve a better master,
Still your heart beats faster
At a word like "free".

O Ariel!
A rebel angel, & a cynic
Overcome by Abdiel,
The zeal of religious zealots.

So much I would say, would I saw Ariel.
Walking peat, Fennario.

O Ariel—
Thou hast been a Camel, once;
Now thou art become a Lion;
When the gyre turneth around,
Thou shalt be as Child.

29

—Be Still A Moment Child—
—There are lessons still to learn here.¹⁰—

Psychedelic wobble,
Creek-cut corso through the
Jungle-lush & tangle.

Then passed vicious dogs
I fended with a walking stick
Toward cachoiras, catch ya later;
And cut past termites' orange adobe,
Old adobe, domed adobe,
Roman concrete secret,
Sunbaked & stigmergic.

Up through red clay beaten
Into stepwell, looping bootstrap, shaw-tie:
Culpture's thousand hardened heels' press
&
Gaia's thousand soft'ning rains.

Lessons like: No architect—

¹⁰ Heronbore, "Vegetable Empire": "Wait. Stay a while.
There is more to be explored here. / Acceptance at this
point creates a lull. Wait here."

Just compounding gesture—
Can discretize a slope so smooth, a
Thousand selfish steps,
The flat spots picked for further pounding,
In desire's trails
Discretize a smooth slope
Into stairway's righteous angles.

Up & up, past shaggy growth
on undergroove of roots,
in shaded grove, & up
Where breeze keeps trees in arcs of
temporary tension,
Keeps the crying hawk in circling
suspension,
With a voice that carries menaces,
Where the prey-lings flutelike chirpings
cheer us,
Little watchlings, watch our power, spill
our beans:
Time current-carves, and stacks in stone.
Accumulates and then erodes
As walkers of a trail lay the trail down
again;
And all the pretty stones on paths are
plucked & pocketed.

30

Flipflops like a Roman sandal
Oiseaux exotiques and
Sunbaked brick & vibora in slitherbrushes
Crossing such a path was
Dudley, young fool Dudley, heel-bitten."

Getting lost in small-scope stories
Getting lost in grandlarge stories
All anxieties are here, in

Reconciling disparate, the
Gap, in checking correspondence,
Keeping up with inbox.

In the frame and interruption
Tagged lightning boltbreak from
Satchitananda.

Went to stay forever in a single second,
but

Distances demand traverse, connections
made, & anyway
Heaven like all company doth spoil in three
days, Kairosclerotic, so will you
find my path? My dear pathfinder.
Art like any art, an
Art intending & attending—
Quiet now, and notice here:
What patterns hast thou seenest ere?
A virgil in the forest dear.

31

"My God! The Source!" you cried from
high,
Shouting Robertin Trwin lines on
Optics over roar of falls, the
New ideas slow-swimming into focus,
Watching white rush carving,
Black rock shaping

"Structuring structure, which is structured
By the flowing force it structures."

Swingvines, far from latticework of
leftbehind city.

I say:

"In other words, everything changes
everything else!"

Which is half true, but feels great in the
moment to say,

Really strong and powerful, thinking how
These impressions on the senses etch in
memory,

Informing here the words I'm forming
Channeling a groove in minds of
Readers—Yours—

32

No Simple Trick Nor Secret, Child—
Just to notice, not to shy from
Truth, intentional attention

Tactics you can borrow,
Suuuuure.
Méchanisms to adapt sure but—

But what?
Each problem different;
Different goals & gods & sense of good &
Different setting,
All the background we're forgetting

Every act unique transform
From global state to state
To state in mécanique form
Not just billiards sure
But what else is change, if not
The pawning mouth of rivers?

So many words & phrases coined
In efforts to control the waters,
Intellect and OODA passionate
expression

Which in simplest term was life, adapting,
reconfigured
Form to meet & match the form that formed
informed sees.

Yesca in the hammock:
 Cricketquiet,
 Beetlebreeze & birdcall
 Smalltown silence,
 Ruffled branches' windfall
 Whispered dogfight
 Butterflies like biplanes
 Particles' positions showing
 Hidden currents
 Like the hawk atop a thermal.

And all the birds in bin'ry rhythm
 Perch, suspend, & perch again
 Perch & fly &
 Rest & risk & rest again
 Glide, exert & glide
 Til distant thunder scatters.

Buffeted by current flows
 & ebbs recurring subtly like
 Fortune's fastest layer fashioned
 from what shoreward ocean washes.

In the morning, up early,
 walk & autosong &
 paracosmic play that's interrupted by a
 century of beetles, still on glassy pool,
 nearby below electric bulbs,
 and flat against the windshield.

Cris kicks his legs in chlorine,
 Tells me how a Language is a set of
 Patterns,
 And the Patterns are the building-blocks
 Of all the story Traces that we tell.

Says Cristobal, this region's known for
 climbing, then corrects my accent:
 "Meu nome é Cristobal"
 I say, fair enough but good luck iambs,
 Other rhythms here resisting meter.

"Check the slicker" he says,
 But no palheiros.
 When I ask for climbing handholds
 What I get are handles:
 Crimps & jugs & pockets & rails,
 In-cuts, slopers; slippery, chaussy, glassy.

Then he gives one of his infamous reports
 from the interior.

Remember: Back in Brooklyn,
 Cris had drunken-staggered
 (Was a tipsybuzz at best;
 This telling's fond of its excess)

-All this money, what does it buy you?
 -All are heavy, drugged up the wazoo.

For gain'o'grain they banner-band together

Like Liberman had felt, regreso
 from thatched Filipino rooves
 And breeze blocks
 "My people full of lightness

-It was something like: A relaxation.
 -It was something like: A lesson
 in negotiation.

Recall—
 (Proleptic analepsis) bite o'
 Meatbeer breakfast, bar o'
 Mushroom chocolate—
 Pargue nauseous, weathered under bower,
 Dozenmile walk,
 Sip finnest rums on Thames

(All overproof) &
Sideline goofing.

"Some folks are just like that— Treasured
by the Gods & better
Off avoiding effort."
(Others in the darkness drill,
Chisel stone to timeless still.)

And me?
A screaming Carioc
Til dawn—
The rain, the fortune's sons
The blueridged mountains, rolling
Rivers, smokehoarse
(Jeff had mimicked Satchmo)
Then, hungover, hair of
Most exquisite science:
Heronbeast—hysterie naked,
Raving night-sweat, bedwet—
"Brotha!"

35

We were frecks.
We were labrats in labrintime.
We were sufferers of zugunruhe.
We were epicormic buds.
Damage to the main trunk activated our
waiting phototropism.

We sped cuntry to seedy,
A classic migration.
Cycling makes analepsis proleptic amidst
Idyllic cars and the echoing birdcalls,
A kind of uniformitarianism,
Prophet's perfect tense not far from
carved stone-time: —Wenn du mich
siehst, dann weine—
Which it was to Kerouac, in "Big Sur",

A fall, like killing Cain, who founded cities,
That book is a book about projecting your
perception onto a landscape,
Like thinking the Heavens were a great dome
overhead,
And then learning of yourself, through the
glints of light that bounce back.

—But how do you choose your form?—
—How do you choose your name? How do
you choose your life?—
—How do you choose the time you must
exhale—
—And kick, and rise?—

In the same way us & all the punguns
Tempted by the views of light that shine
through screens
Of distant wildlife, missed encounters,
curtained parties
Work our way in labrintime and towards
it,
Missing great white light that shines
through keyhole polymorphous
No final form, said Knausgaard—
And what, then, might I risk becoming?

Triune darkness at the edge of town.
Distant Gladerunner ziggurat,
Back to the City of metamours and kipple
Vopodyne & Mordor
Where they eat numbers
Where shiny people dance to shiny music
And gather in the Afters
Of the snake 'n ladders of careers.

And me—voidward, narrowcast & murd'rous
Megaphone midst failson & faildaughter,
Slow beset by paterdreaming
pitter-patter.